CYBER WEEKLY · 24 OCT 2026

Microsoft, SentinelOne and NVIDIA announce ways to secure AI agents

Our view: large vendors now sell control of AI agents as part of their platforms. We also update our seven predictions.

AGENT SECURITY

Microsoft says AI agents are "your newest insiders"

- **Microsoft announced four controls** that limit, score and contain AI agents. One gives each agent a live risk score.
- **Microsoft says it is expanding discovery** to 60 types of agents on users' machines, including Claude Code and GitHub Copilot.
- **It gave no availability date.** It points readers to its Ignite conference, 17 to 20 November.
- **Our view:** Microsoft treats agent risk as an insider problem inside one system, not as a separate product.

SOURCES Microsoft, 19 Oct

SECURITY OPERATIONS

SentinelOne launches a product that finds and controls AI agents

- **SentinelOne's Singularity Agentic Detection and Response** is available now in early access. SentinelOne says it finds AI agents and enforces what they may do.
- **It also launched Singularity ASOC**, an "autonomous SOC" (security operations centre) suite. It gave no availability wording.
- **SentinelOne says** its AI investigation feature has completed more than 400,000 investigations of critical alerts.
- **Our view:** an endpoint incumbent now sells the same "autonomous SOC" pitch as the AI-native challengers.

SOURCES SentinelOne, 21 Oct

PLATFORMS

NVIDIA names 11 security vendors building on its agent-safety design

- **NVIDIA says 11 vendors** are building support for its OpenShell Reference Architecture, a design for running AI agents safely.
- **They include** Microsoft, Palo Alto Networks, CrowdStrike, Cisco, Okta and Zscaler. SentinelOne is not on the list.
- **Palo Alto Networks says** its runtime protection on NVIDIA BlueField chips "is now generally available".
- **Our view:** the point where agent actions are checked is moving into shared infrastructure.

SOURCES NVIDIA, 21 Oct · Palo Alto Networks, 21 Oct

DEALS

Datadog's reported $4 billion approach to Upwind is disputed

- **The Information reports** that Datadog, a cloud-monitoring company, offered about $4 billion for Upwind. Upwind secures cloud systems and AI agents while they run.
- **Globes, citing The Information, says** Upwind turned the offer down. Calcalist says the reported offer "was not made".
- **Neither company immediately responded** to BankInfoSecurity.
- **Our view:** if real, the bidder would be a monitoring vendor, not one of the large security platforms.

SOURCES The Information · Globes, 22 Oct · Calcalist, 22 Oct · BankInfoSecurity, 22 Oct

SHARES

Cyber shares rebounded in the week

- **From 16 to 23 October,** Netskope rose 27.8% and Zscaler 23.0%, by our calculation. The Nasdaq fell 0.7%.
- **Okta rose 13.8%** and CrowdStrike 13.3%, by our calculation. Both won back part of the prior week's fall.
- **TIKR says Friday's rally** followed an Evercore ISI survey of channel partners that found a stronger budget outlook.
- **TipRanks links Friday's gains partly** to a Reuters report that AI models are helping find more software flaws.

SOURCES Yahoo Finance, 23 Oct · TIKR, 23 Oct · TipRanks, 23 Oct

AI MARKETPLACES

Palo Alto Networks now sells through OpenAI's marketplace

- **Palo Alto Networks says** two of its AI-security offerings are "now on the newly launched OpenAI Marketplace".
- **Customers with OpenAI spend commitments** can use them to pay, it says. It gave no prices.
- **Our view:** it is the third tracked vendor in four weeks to sell from an AI-model budget. CrowdStrike and Cyera came first.

SOURCES Palo Alto Networks, 23 Oct

MORE BUSINESS MOVES

Other moves to keep in view

DEAL

Varonis told its partners "for now, nothing changes". It has not yet filed the proxy for its shareholder vote on the Proofpoint deal.

ANALYSTS

Forrester tells buyers to favour shorter terms or contract protections until Proofpoint and Varonis show their integration works.

IDENTITY

Okta says AI agents and Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers can now register by web address instead of a stored secret.

SECURITY OPERATIONS

Proofpoint announced an investigation agent that "will be available in early 2027". The release for its earlier agent still says private preview.

LEADERSHIP

Darktrace named a new chief product officer and chief technology officer.

FUNDING

Blackwall raised $100 million, Trending Topics reports. **Mave raised $34 million** for AI agents in security operations.

PREDICTION UPDATES · OUR ASSESSMENT

Our seven predictions, with evidence since 3 October

PLATFORMS WIN

Supported, unchanged. The platforms keep broadening, but they did not lead this month's deals.

IDENTITY MEETS SECURITY OPERATIONS

Supported, unchanged. Our strongest evidence so far.

DATA POSTURE ABSORBS LOSS PREVENTION

Buying trend supported; replacement not established, unchanged.

BUNDLES SQUEEZE THE MID-MARKET

Supported within that scope, unchanged.

AI TOOL-CALL SECURITY AS ITS OWN CATEGORY

Weakened further, from weakened. Microsoft, SentinelOne and NVIDIA's partners treat the control as part of larger products.

AI-NATIVE CHALLENGERS KEEP AN EDGE

Weakened, unchanged. The evidence cuts both ways.

INSIDER-RISK BRANDS ABSORBED

Unchanged. We found no purchase of a dedicated insider-risk vendor this month.

STORIES TO WATCH

What we are watching next

SECURE EDGE

Netskope Agent Action Control: promised for the end of Netskope's quarter, 31 October by our calculation. Its documentation still calls it "a Beta feature".

DATA SECURITY

Microsoft Purview data loss prevention for non-Microsoft apps: general availability planned for late October.

DEAL

Proofpoint and Varonis: watch for the proxy and a vote date. Close expected in the first half of 2027.

UNCONFIRMED

CrowdStrike and Orion Security; OpenAI and Trail of Bits; Datadog and Upwind: all unconfirmed.

RESULTS

Fortinet and Tenable on 28 October; Check Point 2 November; Varonis 3 November; Rapid7 4 November.

EVENTS

RSA Agent ID: two parts planned for general availability on 16 November. Microsoft Ignite runs 17 to 20 November.

SOURCES

Sources

Company announcements, regulatory filings and reporting behind this week's stories.

COMPANY AND PRIMARY ANNOUNCEMENTS

Microsoft · SentinelOne · NVIDIA · Palo Alto Networks · SEC · Okta · Proofpoint · Darktrace · Mave · Netskope · Fortinet · Tenable · Check Point · Rapid7 · RSA

BUSINESS PRESS, ANALYSTS AND MARKET DATA

The Information · Globes · Calcalist · BankInfoSecurity · Yahoo Finance · TIKR · TipRanks · Forrester · Trending Topics

Full source notes accompany the weekly summary. Full claim-by-claim citations on request.